involved. The archive subsequently published much invaluable material on the Soviet and American experiences of the encounters.[28]

Prominent among these accounts was that of Lieutenant Vadim Orlov, the head communications and intelligence officer assigned to the B-59. Orlov explained how the submarine was pursued over several days by US warships that dropped explosive devices. Then, on 27 October:

> The Americans hit us with something stronger than the grenades – apparently with a practice depth bomb. We thought – that's it – the end. After this attack, the totally exhausted Savitsky, who in addition to everything, was not able to establish connection with the General Staff, got furious. He summoned the officer who was assigned to the nuclear torpedo, and ordered him to assemble it to battle readiness. "Maybe the war has already started up there, while we are doing summersaults here!" screamed emotional Valentin Grigorievich, justifying his order. "We're gonna blast them now! We will die, but we will sink them all – we will not become the shame of the Navy!"[29]

Compare that with the claim made in 1987 by Paul Nitze, assistant secretary at the Pentagon in 1962, who suggested that 'certainly with respect to the seas, we had managed to cause all the Soviet submarines in the vicinity to surface. We had them under control. We had complete local tactical control of the situation.'[30]

It is also striking that crucial details of these events are still emerging. Recent studies by Martin Sherwin and Serhii Plokhy present new accounts of the precise moment when the Doomsday Clock seemed about to strike. Most of what is known of the experience of the Soviet submariners is drawn from thirty- to forty-year-old memories. Some intriguing vignettes have emerged from Soviet records, including the fact that a Project 611 [NATO designation Zulu], the B-88, left its base on the Kamchatka Peninsula on 28 October. Its destination was Pearl Harbor, which it was to attack in the event of war.[31] We do not have much information about other Soviet nuclear deployments in the Atlantic or Caribbean, though the B-75, another